

BOISE GEMS

AUDITION PACKET

BRASS

2026



CONGRATULATIONS!

If you're reading this, then you have made the big decision to audition for the 2026 Boise Gems Brass section. For that, we say **THANK YOU** and congratulations!

We have put together this audition packet to try and make the audition process as simple and straightforward as possible. Start by reading the packet in its entirety and letting the information digest a bit. By the end, you should have a very clear idea as to what we will be looking for during your Boise Gems audition.

We want you to be as prepared and relaxed as possible during your audition. That way, we are getting the **REAL YOU!** Therefore, if you have any questions, feel free to contact one of the staff members below!

Again, thank you for your interest in the 2026 Boise Gems and happy practicing!



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CONTENTS I

INDIVIDUAL EVALUATION

PAGE 3

VISUAL AUDITION

PAGE 4

MUSIC AUDITION / LIST OF EXCERPTS

PAGE 5

INDIVIDUAL EVALUATION I



Whether you're auditioning in person or online, you will simply prepare and perform the provided audition exercises for both visual and music. Everything is selected for you, so there is no need to select your own material.

To better help you understand what the Gems staff is looking for musically and visually during your audition, we wanted to share some general points of focus.

DURING MY AUDITION, WHAT WILL I BE EVALUATED ON?

MUSIC

- Tone quality and Intonation
- Flexibility
- Articulation
- Finger Dexterity
- Range
- Preparation
- Teachability

VISUAL

- Tempo, tempo, tempo!
- Fitness
- A variety of marching exercises
- A variety of dance and body movements
- Teachability
- Did we say tempo?

Outside of your musical and visual talents, we also look at your personality, work ethic, and ability to respond to corrective criticism. These are equally important, especially when push comes to shove in the heat of the summer!

Remember, if you have questions about any aspects of your audition, please contact one of the staff members listed above and/or visit the website to find additional information!

VISUAL AUDITION I

For the visual portion of the audition, rather than pull performers individually for a one-on-one audition, prospective members will be evaluated on their visual performance in a rehearsal setting. This will allow the staff to get a more accurate read on how you, as a prospective member, act in a rehearsal environment as well as how quickly you learn and adapt to instruction.

BE READY FOR

- Group stretch (with focus on body awareness and alignment)
- Across the floors (with a focus on maintaining performance quality through a variety of body movements)
- Introduction and full breakdown of our “long leg” technique
- Basic marching exercises consisting of front and back strides as well as slides



Please note, it is important that you wear athletic clothes and athletic shoes at all Gems auditions!

VIDEO AUDITIONS

If you cannot make it to one of the in-person audition camps, we still want to see you! To submit a video audition, simply record yourself doing the exercises listed below, compile them into one video along with your music portion, and submit via the “Submit Video Audition” form on the Boise Gems website located under “Audition Information.”

REQUIRED EXERCISES

- Skips
- Move 12, Halt 4, Forward: 90bpm
- Move 12, Halt 4, Backward: 90bpm
- Move 12, Halt 4, Forward: 180bpm
- Move 12, Halt 4, Backward: 180bpm
- Step Size Changes: 16 at 16 to 5, 8 at 8 to 5, 12 at 4 to 5 (180bpm)

[CLICK HERE FOR VIDEO EXAMPLES OF THE REQUIRED VISUAL EXERCISES!](#)

PHYSICAL FITNESS

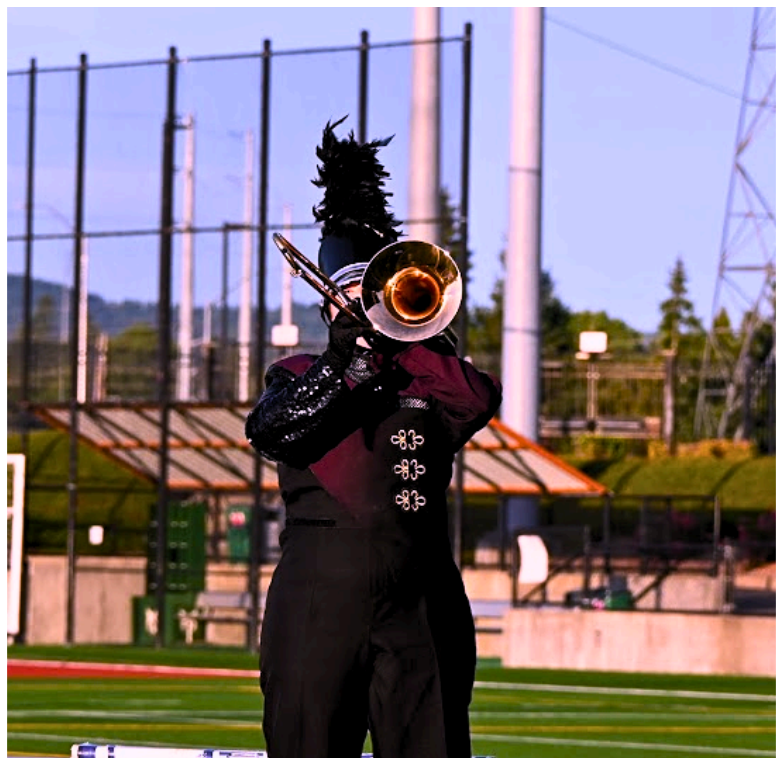
The physical exertion and overall demands put on performers in drum corps these days is equal to professional athletes. Like a professional athlete, a drum corps member needs to stay in great physical shape in AND OUT of the season. The better physical shape you are in for your audition, the more successful your prospective summer will be!

MUSIC AUDITION I

LIST OF EXCERPTS

WHAT TO EXPECT FOR YOUR MUSIC AUDITION

Your playing audition will last around 5 to 10 minutes. Whether you're in person or submitting a video, starting off by letting us know a few things about yourself, such as your age or marching experience before you play will help get things rolling. Although you'll have had time to warm up, you can always take a minute to re-warm once you get into the audition room. Once it comes time to play, the most important thing is... **DON'T BE NERVOUS!** At Gems, one of the things we pride ourselves in is that we **GO FOR IT!** Come prepared and take the audition seriously because, although you don't have to be the best player in the world to be a part of our organization, you **DO** need to have pride and dedication to your instrument. This is a huge event in most people's lives, take full advantage of it!



[CLICK HERE TO ACCESS THE REQUIRED
AUDITION EXERCISES AND EXCERPTS](#)

TRUMPET EXCERPTS

Chromatic
Lip Slur 1
Andante Cantabile
Andante

MELLOPHONE EXCERPTS

Chromatic
Lip Slur 1
Andante Sostenuto
Allegro Grazioso

BARITONE / EUPHONIUM EXCERPTS

Chromatic
Lip Slur 1
Moderato
Allegro Con Anima

TUBA EXCERPTS

Chromatic
Lip Slur 1
Moderato
Adagietto Cantabile

*For more audition information, visit
boisegems.org!*